

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager for observability and infrastructure platforms.*

Positioning, ten years shipping data platforms, analytics products, and infrastructure tooling – now applying that stack to Akamai's observability portfolio.

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§ WHY AKAMAI

Akamai's observability work sits at an unusual intersection: the telemetry pipeline has to be reliable enough to diagnose the infrastructure that carries the internet's most demanding traffic, while the product surface – dashboards, alerts, APIs – still needs to be simple enough for engineers under incident pressure to use without friction. That is a genuinely hard product problem, not a cosmetic one. The job description calls out rationalising a portfolio through consolidation and EOL initiatives, which is the kind of structural work that requires both engineering credibility and stakeholder discipline – two things I have done directly at Rohde & Schwarz and the Federal Employment Agency. *That combination of infrastructure fluency and portfolio-level thinking is exactly where I operate best.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My observability experience is adjacent rather than direct: I have owned data pipelines, ETL platforms, audit trails, and infrastructure tooling, but not a commercial metrics-and-alerting product in a CDN or cloud context. The transferable mechanic is strong – designing for the engineer-under-pressure user, owning complex data flows end to end, and writing requirements precise enough for distributed engineering teams to execute without hand-holding.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, spec drafting, edge-case generation, PRD iteration
 - **GPT**, research synthesis and stakeholder communication drafts
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support and test generation
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted codebase navigation and refactoring
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for user-facing flows
 - **Framer**, design-heavy wireframing and interactive mockups
 - **Gamma.app**, structured presentation and documentation output
 - **n8n**, multi-step workflow automation and agent loop orchestration
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Django, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Redpanda, REST APIs, MicroStrategy, GitOps pipelines, CI/CD with full test integration.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTESTING ENGINE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A crypto market backtesting framework built from scratch for algorithmic strategy validation.

- Ingests historical OHLCV and order-book data across centralised and decentralised venues for strategy replay.
- Built on a file-queue-based agent loop with modular strategy plugins, enabling parallel parameter sweeps.
- Integrates liquidation heatmap data from Coinglass and Hyblock Capital for market microstructure analysis.
- Demonstrates hands-on data pipeline ownership and the kind of systems thinking the observability role demands when reasoning about metric fidelity and alert precision.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT AKAMAI

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the engineering and customer success teams to understand how metrics, dashboards, and alerts currently flow from instrumentation to customer action, and document where the handoffs break.

WEEK 2

Audit, prioritise, slice.

Map the existing portfolio against active customer use cases, identify consolidation candidates, and draft a first-pass prioritisation framework with clear acceptance criteria for the highest-friction areas.

WEEK 3+

Ship, unblock, close loops.

Deliver the first completed PRD through full review with engineering and design, establish a recurring feedback loop with customers, and begin executing the first EOL or rationalisation item end to end.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Akamai Observability Team,

Observability products live at a precise point of tension: the customer using them is almost always in distress – an alert fired, a latency spike appeared, something broke – and the product has to be fast enough, clear enough, and precise enough to help them recover before the problem compounds. Building for that user under that condition requires the same discipline I applied at Rohde & Schwarz, where I was responsible for audit trails, data provenance, and transparent evaluation pipelines for a multimodal AI platform in a government defence programme. The engineer running diagnostics at 2 a.m. and the ML researcher needing reproducible data lineage are solving different problems, but they share the same demand: the system must tell the truth clearly and without noise.

At the Federal Employment Agency I owned an analytics platform – the Arbeitsmarktmonitor – from ETL through to the dashboard layer. I introduced Dagster for automated indicator

generation, migrated legacy infrastructure to Kubernetes, standardised CI/CD, and served as Deputy IT Security Officer. That role required exactly the combination Akamai describes: understanding the data flow deeply enough to spec it correctly, and communicating clearly enough with non-technical stakeholders that governance decisions actually landed. I also did the less glamorous work: deprecating old modules, aligning on compliance boundaries, and keeping delivery moving when the operational surface was larger than the team could cleanly own.

Portfolio rationalisation is one of the harder PM responsibilities because it asks you to take something away rather than add something new. At Emil Group I inherited an InsurTech platform where a 17-person team had accumulated technical debt and delivery chaos in equal measure. I split the team into smaller Scrum units with clear ownership, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and rebuilt client trust through weekly product workshops. Several module consolidations happened as a direct consequence of that structural reset. The experience taught me that EOL and rationalisation work is as much about stakeholder sequencing and honest communication as it is about product strategy.

On the technical side, I am fluent enough in the stack to read infrastructure diagrams, reason about trade-offs in data pipelines, and write acceptance criteria that engineers do not need to reinterpret. At Rohde & Schwarz I unblocked an OpenShift infrastructure issue independently – a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year – and delivered it in one week. That kind of hands-on fluency is what lets a PM write precise PRDs rather than vague ones, and it is what I would bring to defining requirements for metrics ingestion, alerting logic, and API surface decisions at Akamai.

I would like to learn more about the current state of the observability portfolio – specifically where consolidation work is already in flight and where customer feedback is pointing most clearly. I am available for a conversation at your convenience.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Technical Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience owning data platforms, analytics pipelines, and infrastructure tooling in regulated, high-stakes environments. Shipped production systems across ETL, audit trails, dashboards, and Kubernetes-based deployments. Comfortable writing PRDs precise enough for distributed engineering teams, running stakeholder alignment across business and engineering simultaneously, and doing the structural portfolio work – consolidation, EOL, team reset – that most PMs avoid. Operated as Deputy IT

Security Officer, managed GitOps-based rollouts, and delivered features end to end when engineers were blocked.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Data pipeline and ETL product ownership, concept to production
 - PRD authoring with precise acceptance criteria and edge-case coverage
 - Infrastructure fluency: Kubernetes, GitOps, CI/CD, OpenShift
 - Stakeholder alignment across engineering, compliance, and business
 - Portfolio rationalisation and EOL execution
 - Analytics platform delivery: dashboards, indicators, admin tooling
 - Cross-functional team structuring and delivery reset
 - AI-native product execution and rapid prototyping
 - Deputy IT security officer experience, governance and data lineage
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Designed and delivered data provenance, audit trails, and reproducible transformation pipelines for a multimodal AI platform (image, audio, tabular) within the FCAS European defence programme
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end to end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout with ArgoCD
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps
- Unblocked infrastructure-level OpenShift issues independently; delivered a feature requested for over a year in one week
- Enabled transparent ML evaluation concepts including SafeAI and ExplainableAI on curated datasets
- Led cross-functional team spanning architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA

Tech: Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redpanda, Kubernetes, Argo Workflows, ArgoCD, OpenShift

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Owned the Arbeitsmarktmonitor, an analytics platform for regional labour market and demographic data, delivering new features including labour shortage analytics and flexible regional comparison
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; designed interactive dashboards, tables, and community features
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time

Tech: Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Kubernetes, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation on a B2B InsurTech platform
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline by splitting a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units with ownership and deputy concepts
- Rebuilt client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement; reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

Tech: Low-code platform, Java, HTML/CSS, Kubernetes, REST APIs

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and document storage across iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows
- Communicated technical complexity of legacy APIs and external databases transparently to clinical stakeholders to maintain delivery trust

Tech: AngularJS, Ionic, Python, Kubernetes, CGM API integration

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner & Deputy IT Security Officer

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption features on a quantum-secure encryption product (one-time-pad keys, true random number generator hardware)
- Served as deputy IT security officer; responsible for attack vector mitigation and security governance
- Designed for setup under two minutes with no technical knowledge required

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone, including PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO & Head of HR

- Established full digital tooling, ERP introduction, financial and investment planning for a nanotechnology startup in vertical indoor farming

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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